

We mentioned that this pattern was intercepting any URLs starting with ‘admin/’ and passing them along to the admin app that ships with Django.

As a side note, we can do something similar with our CMS app, which is to move all our CMS URLs to a ‘urls.py’ file in our ‘cms’ app folder and include it as above.

Coming back to our admin panel, if you try to open it now by visiting ‘<http://localhost:8000/admin/>’ you will be faced with a login dialog and no way to register a new account. The admin panel allows us to create new users and log in, but to use the admin panel we first need to be able to log in. A catch-22, one was about due by now.

So how do we log in? To break from this cycle Django includes a management command called ‘createsuperuser’ that walks you through creating a new admin account. It can be used as follows:

- `python3 manage.py createsuperuser`

When you execute the above command it will ask you for a username, an email and a password; these are basic requirements of any user account. With this new user created, you can now log in using the admin URL.

In its current state you will see that the admin panel will have two models to edit, Users and Groups. Try them both, try creating new users and groups, edit your newly created user account.

Any users you create will not be able to access this admin panel by default, even if you give them the permission to do so. To give users access to the admin panel you need to mark them as a staff. Only staff users can log into the admin panel. Being able to log into the admin panel doesn’t give them the ability to do anything else though. Unless given correct permissions they will not be able to add / edit / remove anything.

A quick way to give a user permission to do everything is to mark them as a superuser. This gives the user all permissions automatically.

Using our Models via the Admin Site

What we’d really like to see on the admin panel though are our own models, so we can add articles, images, galleries and tags. It turns out this is very simple, just register the models with the admin site framework in the ‘admin.py’ file. You can register a model with the admin framework as follows:

- `admin.site.register(Article)`

We can register all our models in just a few lines of code:

- `from django.contrib import admin`
- `from cms.models import *`